Executive Summary

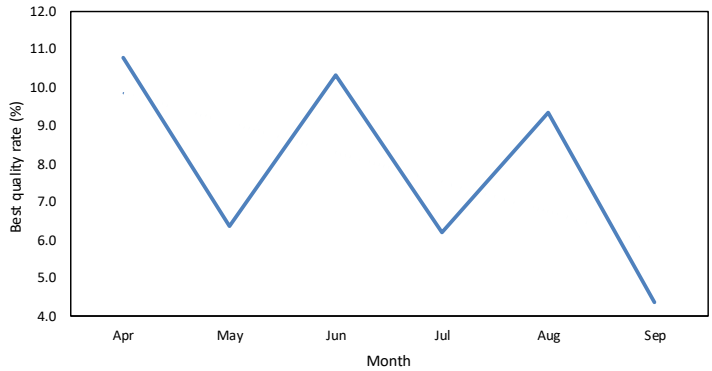
This report assesses lead quality and its drivers. From April to September, the closed lead performance dropped significantly. While we have solid volume, our conversion rate to "Closed" has slipped to a baseline of 8.1%. We have a major opportunity to secure a 20% CPL increase if we can push that conversion rate up to 9.6%.

After digging into the data, it’s clear that we aren't just seeing random fluctuations. We have specific segments that are damaging to our overall average. We’ll reach the goal by removing low intent leads from Student Debt and the 7’500-10’000 brackets. Adding friction to Google Display traffic will further boost quality, taking us straight to the 10% projected rate. We can realistically project a quality rate of 10.0%, which secures our pay increase while making life much easier for the advertiser’s sales team.

1. Lead Quality

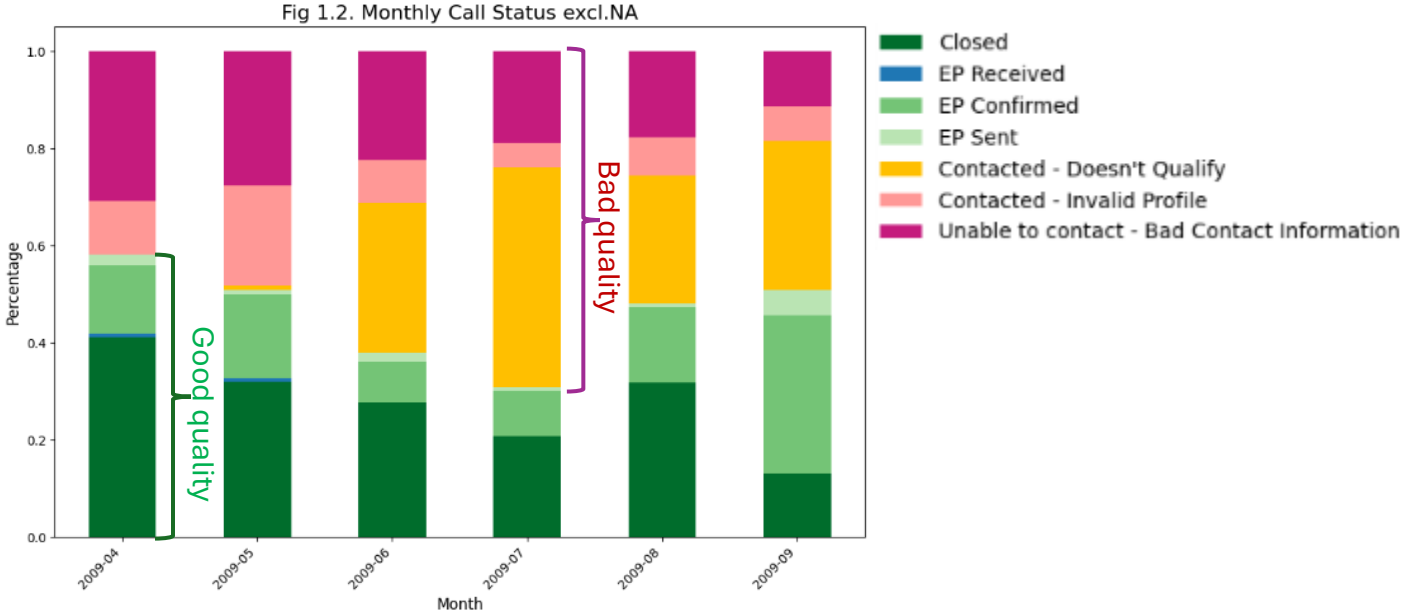
The lead quality declined significantly from April to September. The decline is statistically significant, the best quality rate decreased from 10% in April to 4.5% in Sept (Fig 1.1). Quality rate is defined as good quality lead percentage in all the lead. A p-value near zero confirms that this shift was not random, suggesting a fundamental change in our lead generation process or traffic sources after June.

Fig 1.1. Best Quality Rate Over Time



Based on the Call Status trend, we see a decline in successful ('Closed') calls from 40% in April to 13% in September (Fig 1.2). We also see a lead being contacted, but doesn't qualify to continue to increase significantly. Interestingly, the "EP Confirmed" status doubled in September compared to previous months.

Fig 1.2. Monthly Call Status excl.NA

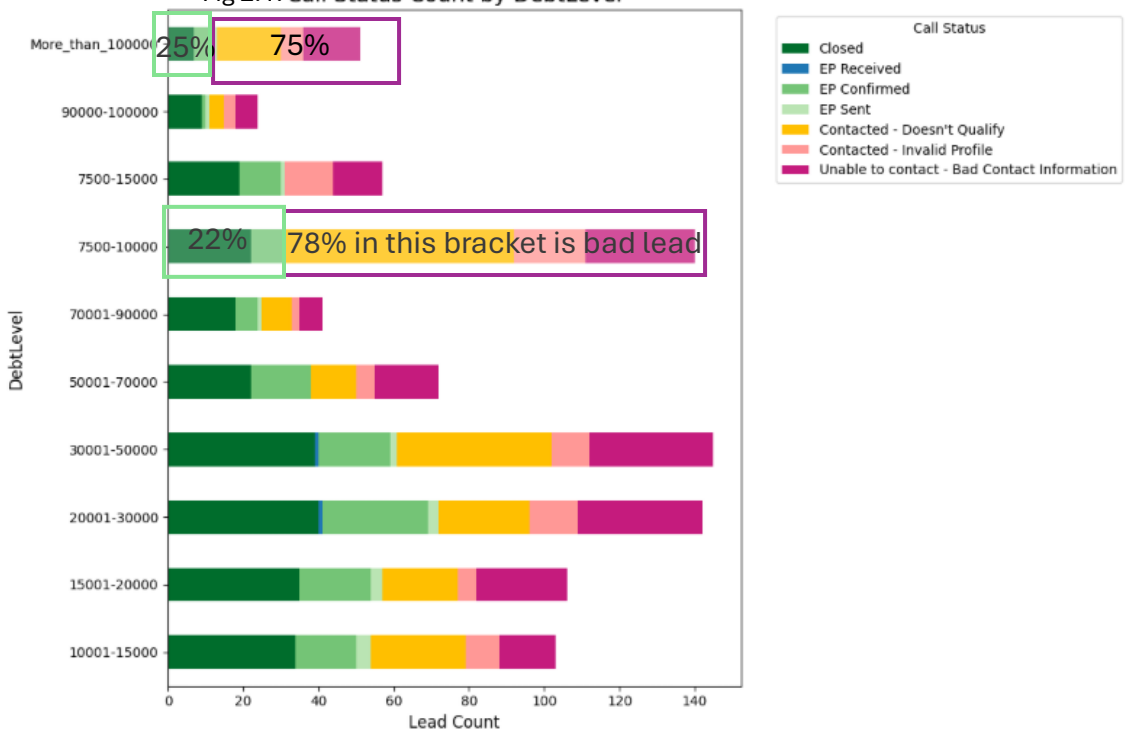


2. Drivers of Lead Quality[1]

Debt level is a significant predictor of lead quality. Individuals with 70'001–90'000 in debt have the highest quality rate, with a 13.7% Conversely, people who reported 7,500–10,000 in debt have a disproportionately high rate of bad quality leads at 78%, compared to only

22% good quality leads. Less than a quarter of the leads in this bracket are considered good. This specific bracket also has the highest percentage of customers who were contacted but did not qualify, suggesting they fall below the advertiser's minimum requirements. Another group that shows low ratio of good to bad quality lead is more than 100’000. Their income-to-ratio is too low to qualify for programs (Fig 2.1).

Fig 2.1. Call Status Count by DebtLevel



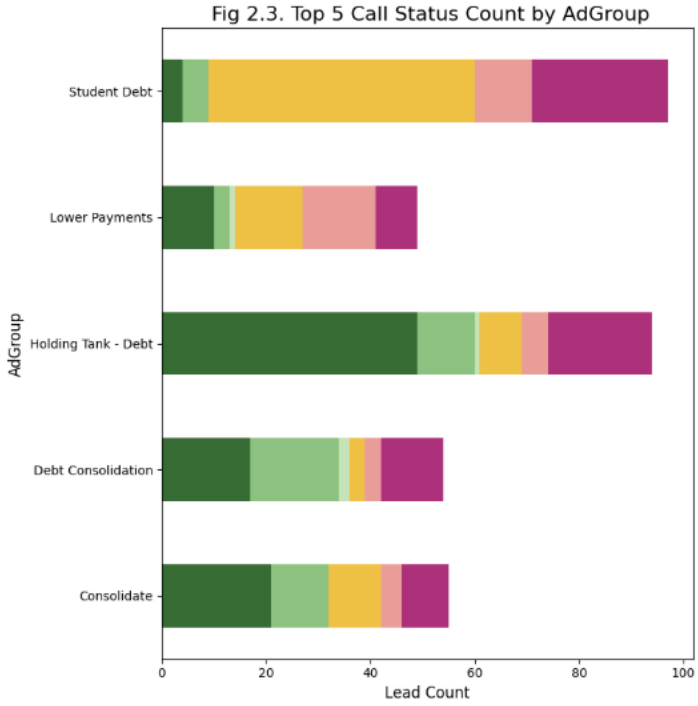
Note: [1] Indicates that Good lead includes – Closed, EP Sent, Received, and Confirmed. For simplicity purposes, good quality is defined as good lead divided by all leads excluding NA.

In June, the 7'500–15'000 bracket was split into 7'500–10'000 and 10'001–15'000. Notations show there is often not enough debt to qualify for amounts less than 10'000, which is likely the hard threshold for the advertiser. Every lead in the 7'500–10'000 bracket was generated via a single page form. This clearly indicates that an extra page in the form helps filter out bad leads.

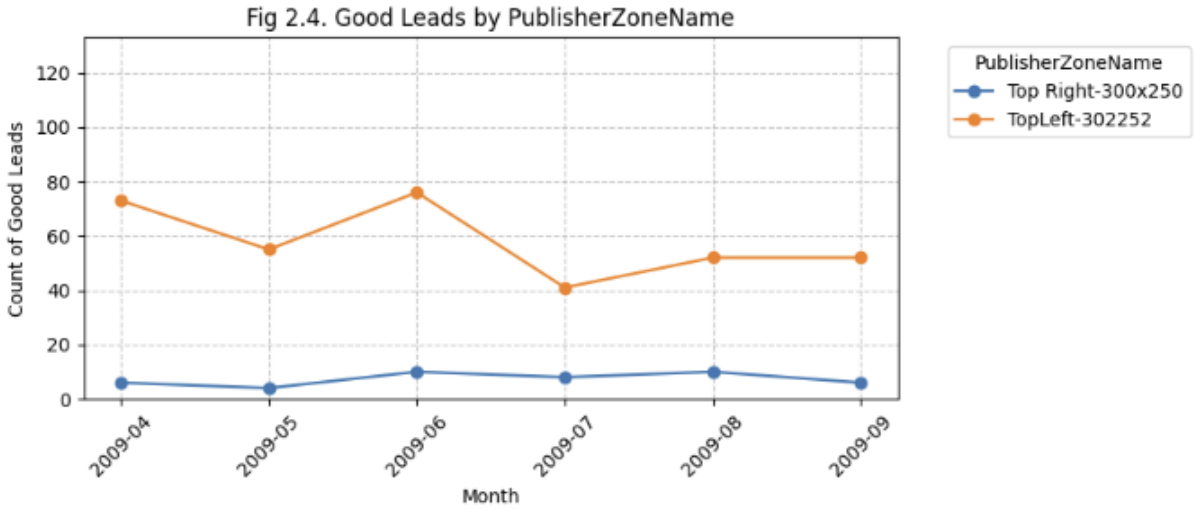
While single page forms drive the most volume, they also generate the highest number of bad leads. Conversely, 2 page forms have a higher quality rate of 48.8% and virtually no instances of Doesn't Qualify or Invalid Profile leads. The extra step serves as a friction point that effectively filters out low intent users.

Furthermore, the Ad Group targeting specific consumer needs directly impacts the lead’s ultimate disposition. The Student Debt and Student Debt High Volume Ad Groups are the poorest performers, with quality rates of 9.3% and 0% respectively. These users are seeking a specific type of relief that the advertiser does not provide. In contrast, users clicking on

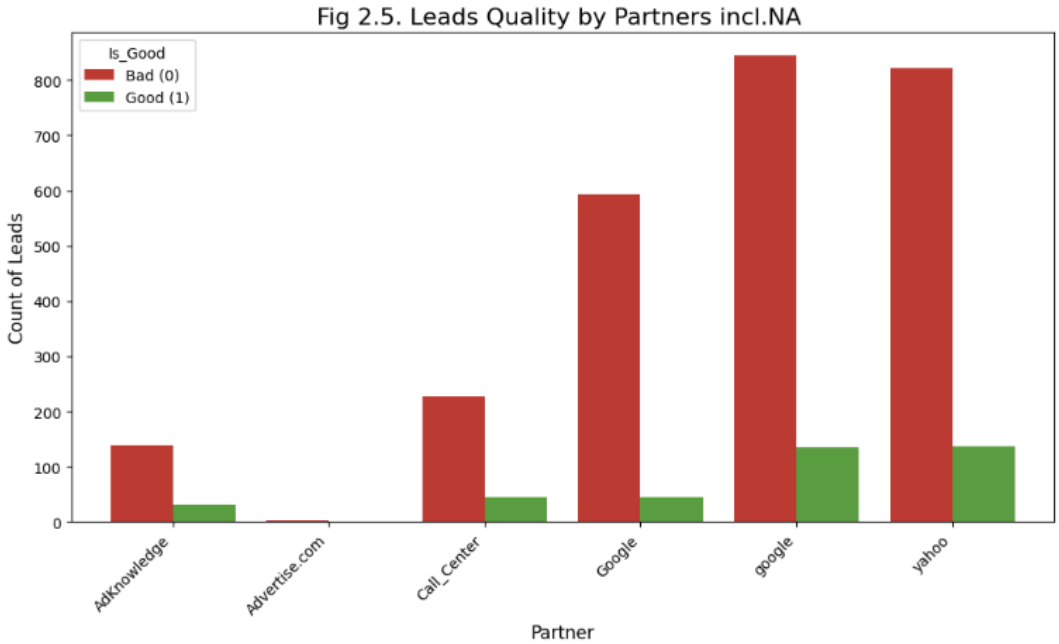
Debt Negotiation (80% quality) or Debt Consolidation (66.7% quality) show the highest conversion potential because their needs align with the advertiser's service (Fig 2.3).



The TopLeft-302252 zone is the most efficient placement, driving the majority of "Closed" volume with a steady conversion rate of 45.3% among known dispositions (Fig 2.4).



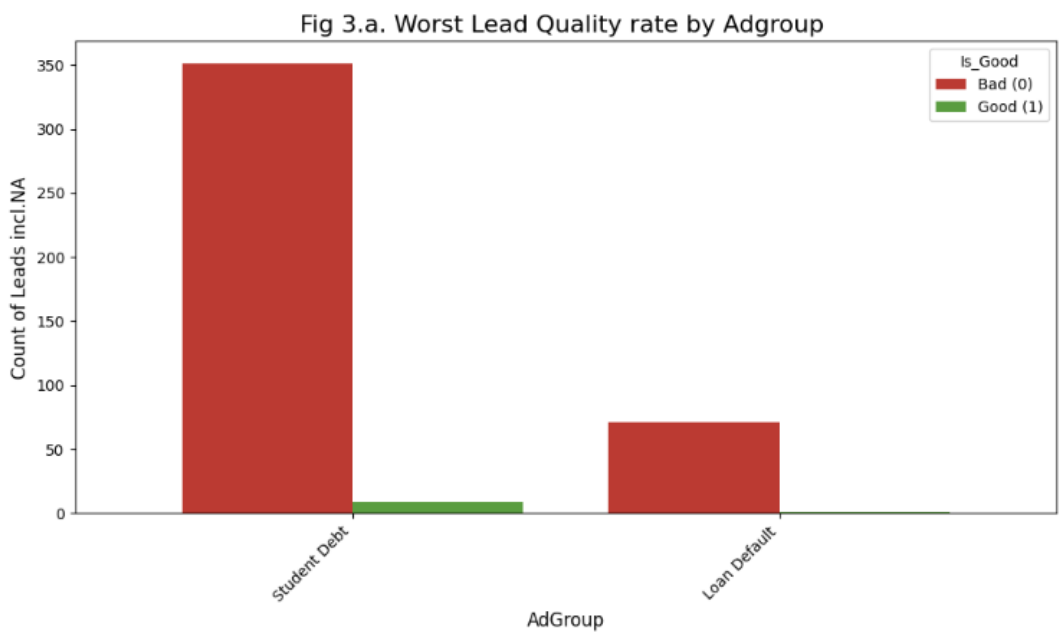
'google' search partner has an overall quality rate of 46.4%, whereas the 'Google' display partner lags behind at 31.9%. Leads from google search traffic consistently outperform leads from Google display clicks. Display traffic is currently responsible for the highest volume of "Bad Contact Information" and "Invalid Profile" leads (Fig 2.5).



3. Strategy for 20% Quality Increase (8.0% to 9.6%)

In order to achieve 20% quality increase, we can cut traffic from bad sources and increase high-performing volumes.

a. Eliminate the student debt and loan default AdGroups (Fig 3.a)



- These two AdGroups generated 389 leads but resulted in only 4 closed sales (a 1% best quality rate).

- Removing these segments immediately removes low-quality volume that is currently dragging down the overall average.

b. Filter Out the 7’500-10’000 and 100’000+ Debt Bracket:
    - This bracket accounts for 442 leads but only 22 closed sales (a 5% quality rate).
    - By disqualifying these leads on the form (e.g., using a hard filter that prevents submission for those with <10’000 debt), we significantly boost the concentration of high-intent users in the final lead pool.

c. Mandatory 2-page form for Display Partners:
    - Since1-page form widgets drive all the "Doesn't Qualify" leads, switching our lower-performing partners (like the Google Content Network) to 2-page forms will act as a natural filter. This will eliminate the 7.1% of bad leads that current 1-page forms generate.

d. Widget Performance:
    - The 'w-300250-DebtReduction1-1DC-Head3' variation showed a low quality rate of 6.7%.

If we pause all AdGroups with 0% quality rates along with the Student Debt, 7'500–10'000, and w-300250-DebtReduction1-1DC-Head3 categories, our overall quality rate is projected to rise from its current 8.1% to 10.0%. This exceeds the advertiser’s target of 9.6%, securing the 20% CPL increase while also significantly reducing the work required by the advertiser’s sales team to filter through non-qualified leads.

We will achieve this by shifting budget allocation from low-performing to high-performing categories. Specifically, we should shift marketing budget from low-intent Google Display segments toward Yahoo and Google Search partners. For any remaining Display traffic, we must mandate the use of 2DC forms to increase friction and ensure higher lead intent.

To validate these changes, we can implement A/B testing. For example, we can test if a group given a 2-page form shows improved lead quality compared to a 1-page form. Additionally, we can test if a group with a hard filter of 10'000 or more debt improves lead quality by preventing unqualified submissions from reaching the advertiser.